REACH SOCIAL CASE STUDY

Category: Food and beverage

A Client-Requested Test Failed. *The Month Still Closed at $161K.*

A food and beverage brand lost a month of TikTok Shop GMV to a test that didn't work — then grew 45% month over month by moving spend back to what converts.

VERIFIED TIKTOK SHOP PARTNER

+45%	**$161K**	**~$50K**
MONTHLY GMV, MOM	RECOVERY-MONTH GMV	DERIVED MOM DELTA

01 Setup

A food and beverage brand doing six figures a month on TikTok Shop. Monthly GMV sat at $111K, with ad spend distributed across the channels and content that had earned their place on performance rather than preference. The shop ran as a retail channel, not a social experiment — steady, measured, compounding. That baseline is the point of this case study. It is what the following month had to be rebuilt from.

02 Problem

The client asked for a test. We ran it. It did not work. That is the honest version. The test consumed budget for a month and cost the account GMV it would otherwise have booked. Not catastrophic — but a month is a month, and on TikTok Shop a month of misallocated spend costs you more than the revenue. It costs you the signal. Campaigns that do not convert teach the algorithm nothing useful, and the content that would have earned traction never got the budget to prove it. So the next month started in a hole: a shortfall to make up, and a growth target that had not moved to accommodate it.

> **Operator note —** the roughly $50K month-over-month delta cited below is derived from the two reported monthly GMV totals. The team reported the GMV figures, not a separate financial-impact number.

03 The GMV Recovery Reallocation

The GMV Recovery Reallocation is what you run when a test fails and the month still has to land. Most agencies handle a failed test one of two ways. They defend it — reframe the loss as a learning and ask for more runway. Or they retreat — pull back to a safe, flat month and hope the client stops asking. Both cost the client money. The third option is to treat the failed test as a budget release event. Spend that was locked up in something that did not work is now free. It does not get returned. It gets redeployed, immediately, into the parts of the account with the shortest proven path from dollar to GMV. That is the whole system: fast diagnosis, fast reallocation, and a rebuild sized for recovery plus growth rather than recovery alone. You are not trying to get back to even. Even is last month's number, and last month's number was already behind.

04 The moves

Reallocate

Ad budget came off the failed test and went back into the campaigns with documented conversion behavior. No hedging, no slow taper to protect anyone's feelings about the test. The spend moved to where the return was already proven.

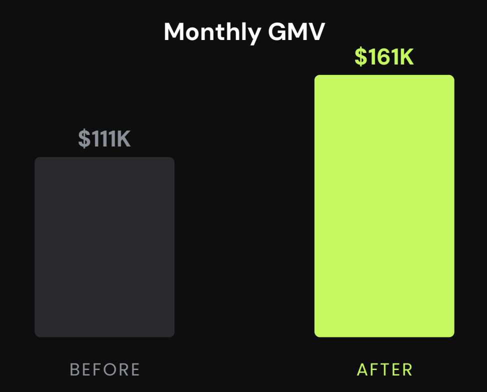
Rebuild

The month was rebuilt around the channels and content that had already demonstrated they convert for this brand — not a fresh round of experiments. The stated goal was to make up the lost GMV, not to hold steady, so the plan was sized against the shortfall and the growth target together.

05 Result

Monthly GMV came in at $161K — up 45% month over month from $111K. That is recovery and growth in the same number. The month did not just replace what the failed test cost. It cleared the prior baseline by roughly $50K in a single month-over-month step, on a reallocation of budget already inside the account.

MONTHLY GMV, BEFORE VS AFTER



Prior month $111K → recovery month $161K. Both figures are reported monthly totals; the roughly $50K delta between them is derived.

$111K	$161K	+45%
MONTHLY GMV BEFORE	MONTHLY GMV AFTER	MONTH OVER MONTH

The read that matters is not the 45%. It is that the 45% arrived the month after a failure. Anyone can post a growth number on a clean month. The real test of a TikTok Shop management relationship is what happens when an idea does not work — the client's idea, in this case. Does the account stall while everyone relitigates the decision? Or does the budget move that week and the month still land? Here it landed. The system absorbed a failed test and delivered growth anyway, which is a different and more durable claim than a good month on top of a good month.

06 Operator takeaway

Run TikTok Shop as retail and you plan for failed tests the way retail plans for a bad endcap: as a budget event, not a crisis. Three things make that possible. You need a documented view of which channels and content actually convert for the brand, built before you need it — you cannot reallocate into "proven" if you never defined proven. You need the authority to move spend fast, agreed with the client up front, so the reallocation does not wait on the next scheduled call. And you need to size the rebuild against the shortfall plus the target, not the shortfall alone. Test freely. Most tests fail; that is what makes the ones that work worth finding. But the account that can absorb a failed test without losing the month is running a system. The account that cannot is running a series of hopes.

Want a TikTok Shop account that can absorb a bad month?

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